



“This is not a content problem, it’s a big discovery problem”

MAE MARIYAM THOMAS ON THE THREE QUESTIONS TO ANSWER BEFORE YOU BUY A MIC, WHY TWO YEARS IS THE REAL TEST, AND DEMYSTIFYING THE NUMBERS

By **Jayesh Shinde** | editor@digit.in

Mae Mariyam Thomas started *Maed in India* in 2015, when independent podcasting barely existed here. She has since worked across presenting, journalism, production and podcast consulting. Her advice is the least glamorous and possibly the most useful,

including hard numbers on what a download figure is worth. She is also someone who thinks Indian podcasting’s turn towards video is a mistake.

What should a podcaster work out before buying equipment?

Mae: I have 31 questions they need to answer that will help them (and myself)

figure out what they want to do. Let me simplify that to three (and a half) basic questions. What is your show about? Why does it need to exist? Who is this podcast for, and what do you want them to get from it? These questions will help to get to the heart of what your show is – the purpose, the proposition and its value.

How to know if an idea can sustain a show?

Mae: Podcasts are a long game. A lot of people think they can release 10 episodes and gauge whether their podcast will be a success or not. I would say, release your show consistently for two years – release weekly or fortnightly, both